Bereket Tilahun

Backend and security engineer · Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Fixed-price security reviews of Supabase, Next.js and Stripe apps on Upwork. Open to full-time or contract backend and application-security roles, remote or Addis Ababa.

berakhah.github.io · github.com/Berakhah · linkedin.com/in/berekettilahun · Upwork profile

Experience

Senior Software Engineer May 2026 – Present
DZ Software Engineering PLC · Addis Ababa, Ethiopia
Promoted in May 2026. Part-time (20 hours a week) since August 2026.

Software Engineer Jul 2023 – Apr 2026
DZ Software Engineering PLC · Addis Ababa, Ethiopia
Main backend developer on DZ's 15-service platform (FastAPI, Django REST, Docker) from July 2023.

- Added Redis caching to the platform's services; p95 latency fell from 340 ms to 195 ms.
- Built an LLM evaluation pipeline that runs as an automated quality gate on 11 production services, which cut manual review effort by 40%.
- Built a benchmark-curation pipeline over PostgreSQL telemetry and Redis event streams that cut mean time to detect model-quality regressions by 30%.
- Hardened 47 API endpoints with schema validation, parameterized queries, rate limits and Bandit/pip-audit checks before merge.
- Replaced 11 long-lived secrets with short-lived, scope-limited OIDC tokens and made Trivy image scans a blocking deploy step.
- Deployed evaluation services on AWS (EC2, S3, role-scoped IAM, VPC) behind a load balancer; rollback time fell 35%.

Full Stack Developer Mar 2022 – Jun 2023
DZ Software Engineering PLC · Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- Triaged production incidents across Python, Java and C++ services and wrote runbooks for the ones that kept coming back.
- Automated recurring health checks and set up observability baselines for the services I supported.

Freelance Backend Engineer (part-time) Mar 2021 – Jun 2023
Independent, for small organizations · Remote

- Built backends with FastAPI, Django REST and Spring Boot.

Projects

Personal projects, 2026. I design them and direct AI coding agents (Claude Code) that write much of the code; I review and test it. Each repo says how it was built and what isn't finished.

- **ShopFast sample audit** (demo, not client work): a Next.js + Supabase + Stripe store with 8 planted flaws, each proven and paired with its fix.
- **Agent Perimeter** (Apache-2.0): security scanner for MCP servers and AI agents with 34 checks and a passive census of 31,953 MCP Registry entries.
- **Ledger Sense** (Apache-2.0): checks construction pay applications before payment. My own audit of it recorded 34 findings; I reproduced and fixed the Critical one.

Skills

Backend	Python 3.12 · FastAPI · Django REST · Spring Boot · Pydantic v2 · SQLAlchemy 2 + Alembic · PostgreSQL · Redis · Typer CLI
App security	Supabase RLS and Postgres policies (ShopFast) · Stripe webhook and checkout checks (ShopFast) · OIDC / Keycloak, JWT (DZ, AZTDP) · RBAC · OWASP Top 10 · threat modeling · SARIF 2.1.0 · Argon2 · Bandit / pip-audit · Trivy · gitleaks
Web	Next.js and TypeScript (ShopFast, Agent Perimeter UI) · React
Infrastructure	Docker & Compose · GitHub Actions · AWS (EC2, S3, IAM, VPC) · Linux · Prometheus · CI/CD gates
Evaluation	LLM evaluation pipelines · bootstrap confidence intervals · judge agreement (Cohen's κ) · property-based testing (Hypothesis)

Education

B.Sc. Computer Science, HiLCoE School of Computer Science & Technology, Addis Ababa Jan 2021 – Jul 2026
Part-time study, alongside freelance work (2021–2023) and my job at DZ (from March 2022).